

MSX

V9990

USER MANUAL

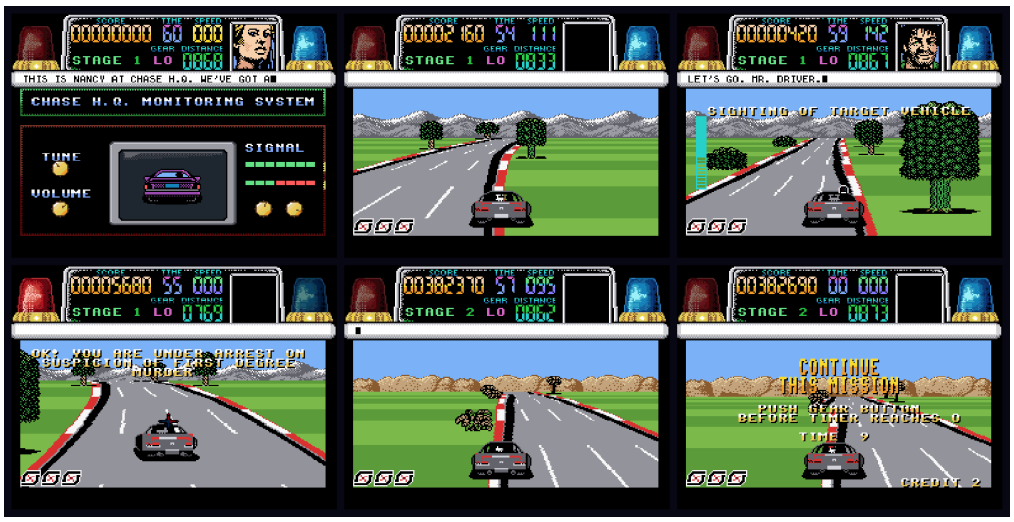
The MSX game on the V9990

CHASE H.Q.

for the Yamaha V9990

MSX V9990

An original game by **Ocean**, 1989.
V9990 port by **DiHalt Studio**, 2026.



This is an unofficial port made for study, preservation, and homage.

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1. What you need

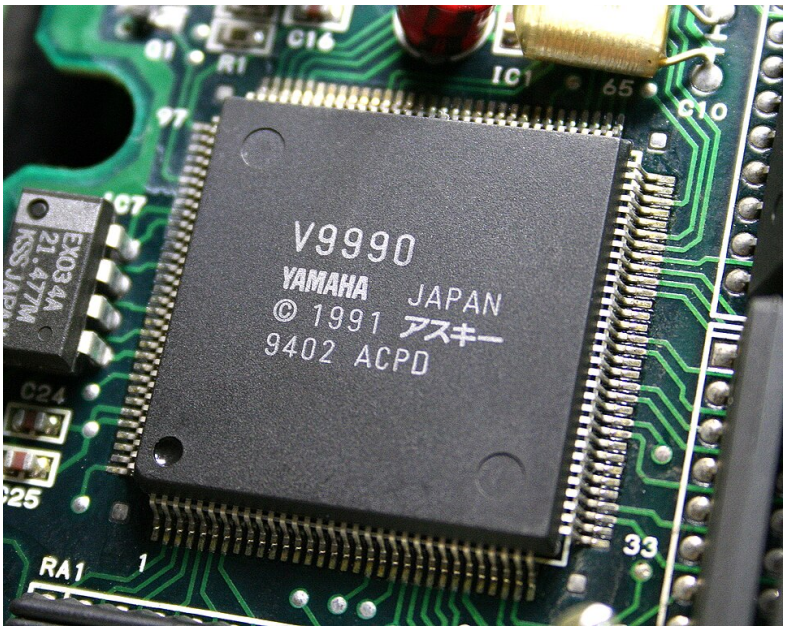


Figure 1: The Yamaha V9990 video processor, the chip this version of the game draws with. Photo: Yaca2671, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 3.0.

Item	Requirement
Computer	**An MSX1, MSX2 or turbo R** with two cartridge slots, one for the game and one for the V9990. On a turbo R the game runs at the same speed as on an MSX1.
Memory	**64 KB of RAM**. An MSX with less memory can still play if the flash cartridge that holds the game has its own memory (for example a MegaFlashROM SCC+ SD): the game uses it.
Video	A **V9990 cartridge** (Yamaha V9990 video). It is mandatory: the whole picture is drawn by the V9990. The computer's own video chip is kept blank on purpose.
Sound	The MSX's own sound: title music, police siren, engine, turbo and effects. No sound cartridge is needed.
Game	The **Chase H.Q. V9990 cartridge**: a 1 MiB ASCII16 MegaROM (the file `chasehq_v9990.rom`, written to a flash cartridge or equivalent). It works with the cartridge in a normal slot or in a sub-slot.
Monitor	A monitor or TV connected to the **V9990's video output**, not to the MSX's own video output.
Controls	The cursor keys and the keyboard, or a joystick with two buttons in port 1.

No tape, no disk, no password. The whole game is in the cartridge.

2. Setting up

1. **Switch the MSX off.** Never insert or remove a cartridge with the power on.
2. Insert the **V9990 cartridge** in one of the cartridge slots.
3. Insert the **Chase H.Q. cartridge** in the other slot. The order does not matter.
4. Connect your monitor or TV to the **video output of the V9990**.
5. Plug a joystick into port 1 if you want to use one. Button 2 fires the turbo.

6. Switch the MSX on. For about two seconds the MSX's own screen shows `OCEAN SOFTWARE 1989`, `DIHALT STUDIO 2026` and `V9990 found !`; then the picture appears on the V9990's monitor. If it says `V9990 NOT found!!!` the V9990 is missing or not seated, and the game stops there.

If the screen stays black check, in this order: the monitor is on the V9990's output; the V9990 and the game are fully inserted; the computer has 64 KB of RAM; the game ROM is the 1 MiB ASCII16 MegaROM build. On an emulator such as openMSX, enable the V9990 extension and load the ROM with the right mapper.

3. From power-on to the game



Figure 2: Left: the cover. Right: the title screen.

1. **Start-up message.** On the MSX's own screen, `OCEAN SOFTWARE 1989 / DIHALT STUDIO 2026 / V9990 found !` for about two seconds.
2. **DiHalt logo.** Shown for four seconds; it cannot be skipped.
3. **Cover.** The illustration of the arcade game. Press any key or a joystick button to continue.
4. **Title screen.** `CHASE H.Q.` with a blinking `PRESS GEAR TO PLAY`; the credits of the MSX version and the copyright take turns underneath. Press **GEAR** (**SPACE** or joystick button 1) to start.
5. **Briefing.** The `CHASE H.Q. MONITORING SYSTEM` screen: Nancy, at Chase H.Q., tells you by radio who the criminal is, and the monitor shows his car. Press **GEAR** to skip it.
6. **The chase.** After each arrest the briefing of the next stage begins. There are five stages; after the fifth comes the ending, and then the title screen.

Between screens the picture goes black for a moment while the next one is prepared. When the game is over, `GAME OVER` appears and the title screen comes back.

4. Controls

The keyboard, the cursor keys and joystick 1 work at the same time.

Action	Keyboard	Joystick
Steer left / right	← →	stick left / right
Accelerate	↑	stick up
Brake	↓	stick down
Change gear, `LO` / `HI` (**GEAR**)	**SPACE**	button 1
Turbo	**M**	button 2
Pause	**P**	
Give up the game	**Q**	
Start, skip the briefing, continue (**GEAR**)	**SPACE**	button 1

Notes.

- Each press of **GEAR** changes between the low gear, `LO`, and the high gear, `HI`. Start in `LO` and change to `HI` when the speed stops rising.
- The **turbo** gives a burst of speed for a few seconds. You have **three per stage**; the icons at the bottom left show how many are left.
- **P** pauses the game and silences it. Press any control to go on.
- **Q** ends the game at once, as if the time had run out with no credits left.
- Pressing left and right, or accelerate and brake, at the same time does nothing.

5. How to play

You and your partner drive the pursuit car of **Chase H.Q.**, the special investigation unit. In each of the five stages a criminal is escaping in his car. Nancy tells you by radio who he is at the start of the stage. Then:

1. **Catch up with him.** The `DISTANCE` counter shows how far ahead he is, and you have **60 seconds**. Overtake the traffic and stay on the road.
2. When he comes into view, `SIGHTING OF TARGET VEHICLE` appears, the **siren** starts, and the clock goes back to **60 seconds**.
3. **Ram his car** again and again. Each ram drains the damage meter on the left of the road; after **20 rams** he gives up, pulls over and is arrested.

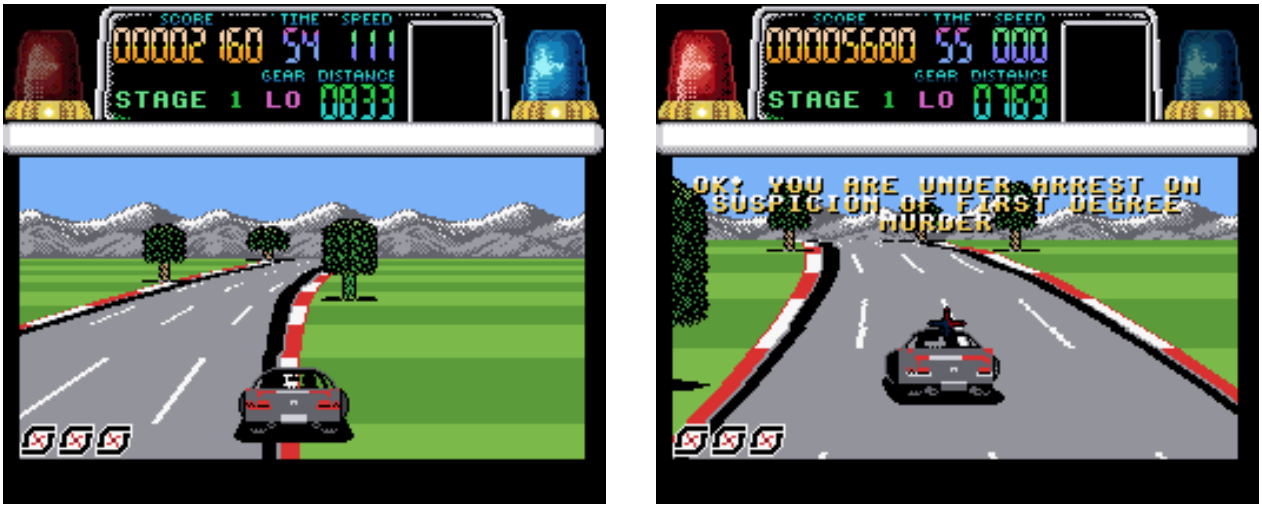


Figure 3: Left: the chase in the first stage. Right: the arrest.

On the road. Crashing into another car or into something at the roadside (trees, signs, fences) spins you round and slows you down. Off the road the car shakes and loses speed. The road goes through tunnels, and sometimes it splits in two. If you drive too slowly for too long, your partner complains.

The radio. The line under the panel shows what is said on the radio, letter by letter, with the face of whoever is speaking: Nancy, your partner or the criminal.

Time up and continue. If the clock reaches zero, `TIME UP` appears. If you have credits left, `CONTINUE THIS MISSION` counts down from 10: press **GEAR** before it reaches 0 to go on with 60 seconds and three turbos, but the criminal's car is repaired. You have **two credits** per game. Without credits, or if you let the count run out, the game is over.

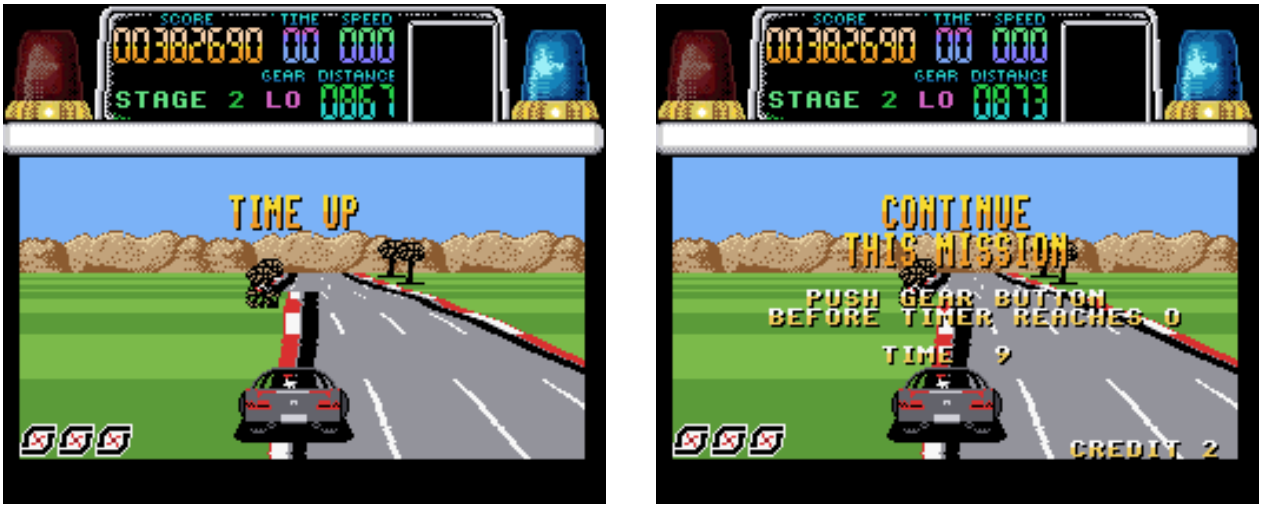


Figure 4: Left: the clock has run out. Right: the chance to continue.

6. The status panel (HUD)

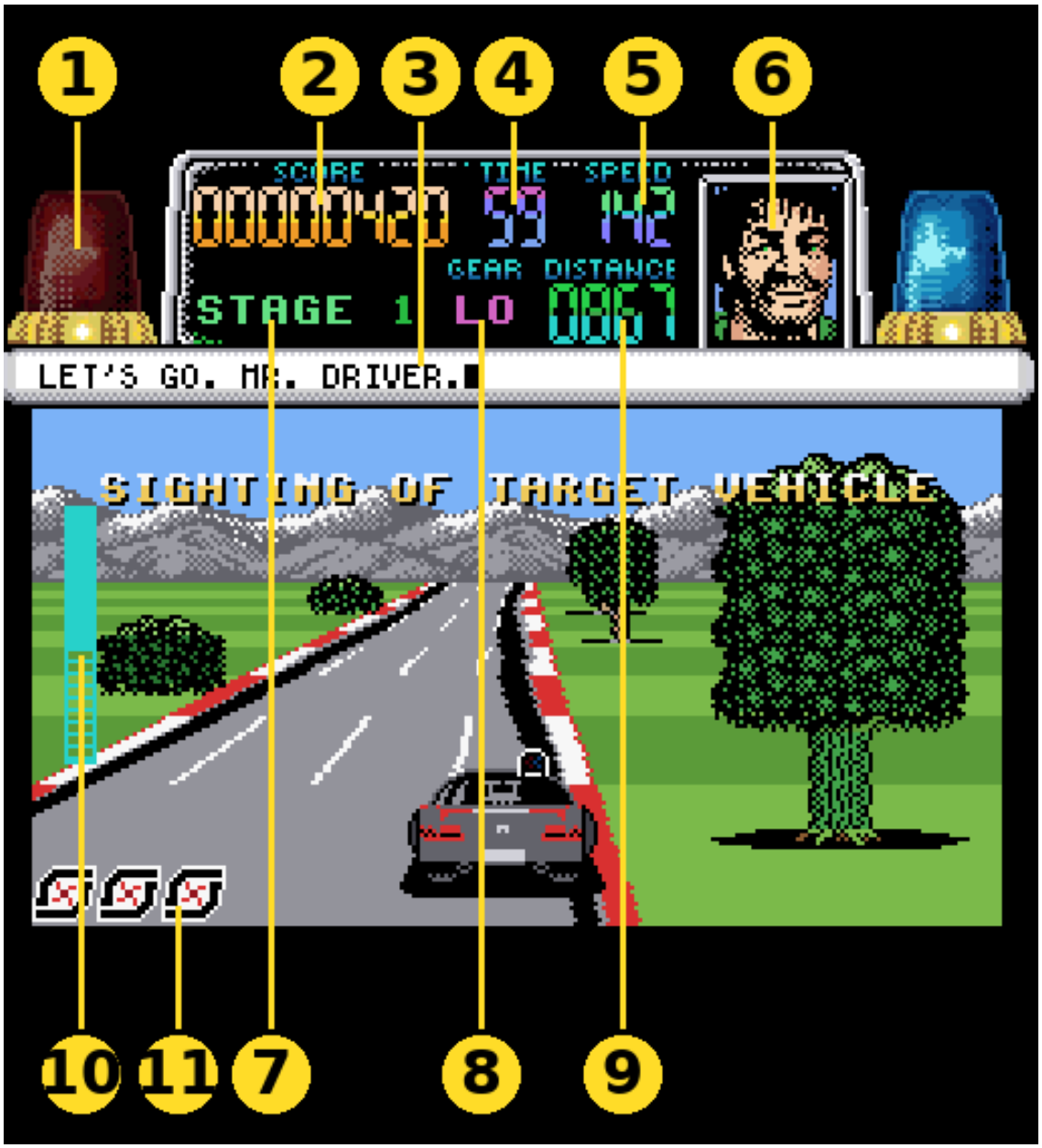


Figure 5: The panel at the top of the screen, and what you see on the road.

No.	Element	What it tells you
1	Sirens	The two police lights. They flash while the siren sounds, once the criminal is in sight.
2	SCORE	Your score.
3	Radio	What is said on the radio, letter by letter.
4	TIME	Seconds left.
5	SPEED	Your speed in km/h.
6	Face	Who is speaking on the radio: Nancy, your partner or the criminal. Static when the radio tunes in.
7	STAGE	The stage you are playing, 1 to 5.
8	GEAR	The gear you are in: LO or HI.
9	DISTANCE	How far away the criminal is.
10	Damage meter	Appears once the criminal is in sight: how much his car can still take. It drains with every ram; when it is empty, he is caught.
11	Turbos	The turbos you have left in this stage.

7. Scoring and credits

- You score points all the time while you drive: the faster, the more.
- **Overtaking** scores too, and each car you overtake is worth more than the one before (200, 400, 600... up to 8 000). Crashing into a car starts the count again.
- Every **ram** on the criminal's car scores points.
- After the arrest you get two bonuses: CLEAR BONUS, **100 000 points for each stage number** (10 000 if you have used a credit), and TIME BONUS, **5 000 points for each second left**.
- There are no lives: you play against the clock, with **two credits** to continue.

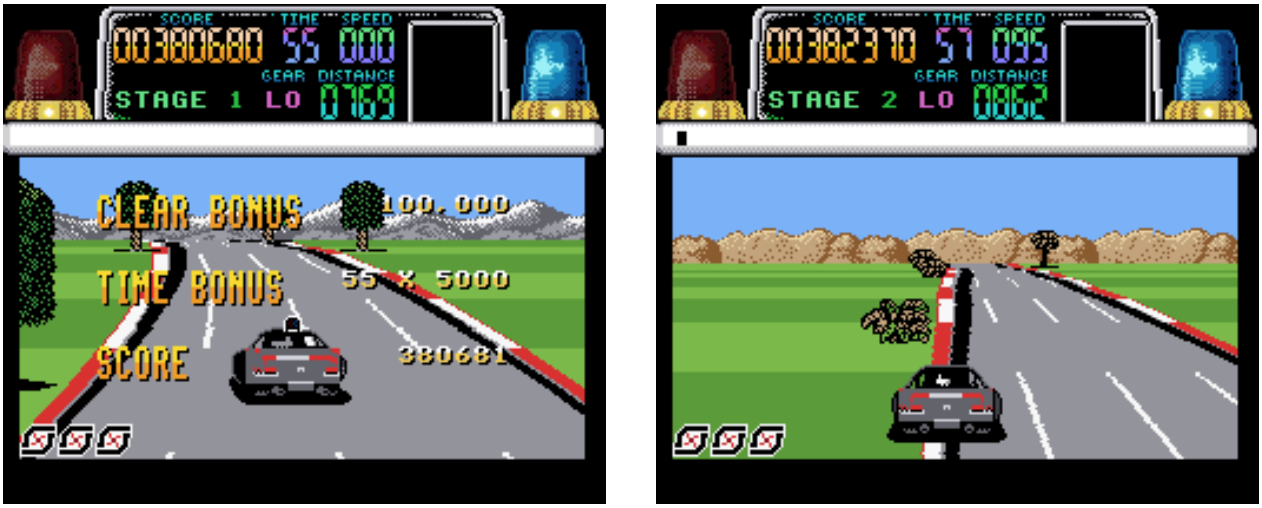


Figure 6: Left: the bonuses after an arrest. Right: the second stage.

8. Tips

- Change to HI as soon as you are moving: in LO the top speed is much lower.
- Keep the turbos for when the criminal is in sight: with the turbo on, you keep more speed after each ram.

- Overtake without touching the other cars: a crash costs speed, time and your overtaking points.
- Stay on the tarmac: off the road you lose speed, and with it time.
- The briefing tells you what car the criminal drives: look for it among the traffic.

9. Credits and rights

- **Chase H.Q.** is a game by **Ocean**, 1989. The game, its graphics, music and name belong to their rights holders. This is an unofficial port made for study, preservation and homage; it is not affiliated with them.
- **V9990 version** (display engine, title screen, editable graphics, sound and music, ending): **DiHalt Studio**, 2026.
- MSX is a trademark of MSX Licensing Corporation. The MSX logo is shown only to say which computers the game runs on (file `MSX-Logo.svg`, Wikimedia Commons).
- V9990 is the name of the Yamaha video chip; the chip photo is by Yaca2671, CC BY-SA 3.0.
- The original **Chase H.Q.** is an arcade game by **Taito Corporation**, 1988. The MSX version by Ocean: program Jobbee, graphics Bill, music Jon Dunn.
- The cover illustration is the artwork of the Taito arcade game. The music and the siren follow the ZX Spectrum 128K version.
- Source code available on GitHub. **Please improve the game if you feel so!**

Appendix. Cartridge label

A label for the cartridge, ready to print. At 100 % it is about 16 cm wide; scale it in your printing program to fit the label area of your cartridge (the artwork has a 3:2 proportion).

